

The Boston Globe

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MGB poised to lay off hundreds

Health system to trim managers amid rising costs

By Jessica Bartlett
GLOBE STAFF

Mass General Brigham said Monday it will let go of hundreds of employees in the next two months, the largest layoff in the organization's history, as the health system grapples with anticipated financial shortfalls and ongoing operational challenges at its 12 hospitals.

With roughly 82,000 employees, MGB is easily the state's largest private employer. Executives declined to say how many people would be let go, but said the target is to save at least \$200 million annually, or approximately 2 percent of its salary and benefits costs. The cuts, which will occur this week and then again in a second round in March, would likely have rolled out more slowly over the course of years as the health system more closely integrates its hospitals, executives said, but have been sped up because of financial pressures.

"We are ... facing the same unrelenting pressures affecting many health care systems across the country that are contributing to a projected budget gap of a quarter of a billion dollars within the next two years," Jennifer Street, senior vice president of communications at Mass General Brigham, said in a statement. "We are acting now to allow us to continue with planned and future investments."

Reductions will be focused on administrative and management levels of the sprawling organization, Street said, and will not affect front-line clinical workers or staff that supports patient-facing care. The system

LAYOFFS, Page A10

Bus riders in Boston could soon see improvements to their commutes under plans to upgrade the traffic signal system citywide. **B1.**

Planet Fitness is gaining notice for a major national expansion. It just opened a new gym in Allston. **D1.**

The man accused of attacking author Salman Rushdie appeared to be "on a mission" as he rushed onstage with a knife, a prosecutor said in the stabbing trial in New York. **A2.**

Investors led by Elon Musk have made a \$97.4 billion bid to buy the nonprofit that controls OpenAI, escalating a yearslong tussle for control of the firm between Musk and OpenAI CEO Sam Altman. **D1.**



Making gloom

Tuesday: Mostly cloudy.
High 33-38, low 21-26.
Wednesday: Partly cloudy.
High 29-34, low 27-32.
Sunrise: 6:46. Sunset: 5:11.
Obituaries, **C10.**
Comics and Weather, **D5-6.**

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White House defies order, judge says

NIH payment cuts blocked but economic fears linger

By Anjali Huynh
and Diti Kohli
GLOBE STAFF

A Massachusetts federal judge on Monday temporarily blocked the Trump administration's effort to drastically reduce federal funding for biomedical research hours after it took effect. But fears still abound over how the proposal could damage the economy and scientific progress across Massachusetts and the

country.

The White House's order, announced Friday, capped reimbursement rates from the National Institutes of Health at 15 percent for so-called "indirect costs." The term refers to money NIH gives institutions where NIH-funded research is taking place to support overhead expenses such as electricity, maintenance staff, or lab space rent — costs

NIH, Page A7

Fight for schools

Activists and lawmakers in Boston denounced threats to dismantle the US Department of Education. **B1.**

A win for unions

A federal judge in Boston on Monday froze the deadline for federal workers to accept a buyout. **B1.**

Battle over data

Administration lawyers argued against a court order blocking Elon Musk's aides from entering Treasury data systems. **A6.**

Ruling sets up potential showdown between Trump, judicial branch on funding

By Mattathias Schwartz
NEW YORK TIMES

A federal judge Monday said the White House has defied his order to release billions of dollars in federal grants, marking the first time a judge has expressly declared that the Trump White House was disobeying a judicial mandate.

The ruling by Judge John J. McConnell Jr. in Rhode Island federal court ordered Trump administration officials to comply with what he called "the plain text" of an edict he issued on Jan. 29.

That order, he wrote, was "clear and unambiguous, and there are no impediments to the Defendants' compliance with" it.

Shortly after the ruling, administration lawyers appealed his initial order to the First US Circuit Court of Appeals, asking the appellate court to pause McConnell's order that seeks to keep federal funds flowing while their case was being considered. The White House responded defiantly.

"Each executive order will hold up in court because every action of the Trump-Vance administration is completely lawful," said Harrison Fields, a White House spokesperson. "Any legal challenge against it is nothing more than an attempt to undermine the will of the American people."

The legal actions on Monday marked a step toward what could evolve quickly into a high-stakes

COURTS, Page A6

IN GAZA, A JOURNEY HOME



EYAD BABA/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

People walked with belongings along the Wadi Gaza Bridge on al-Rashid Street between Gaza City and Nuseirat on Monday as displaced residents returned home. Hamas on Monday postponed the release of more Israeli hostages, accusing Israel's government of violating the six-week cease-fire. **A3.**

Background checks won't lead to shelter evictions

Policy applies even to those convicted of serious crimes

By Stephanie Ebbert
and Deirdre Fernandes
GLOBE STAFF

Governor Maura Healey's new policy requiring additional criminal background checks of all adults in the state's family shelter system has one striking catch: It would not evict anyone who has a criminal record.

The policy, which went into effect in late January, calls for the family of someone convicted of a felony to be moved into more permanent housing — the same goal for all families in shelters — using state programs such as

HomeBASE, which provides \$30,000 in rent aid over two years.

If the family can't find outside housing, officials would ask the person with a criminal record to leave the shelter while their relatives remain, "if feasible," according to the policy. Alternatively, the state would consider moving the entire family to "a setting posing a lower level of risk to other families" within the shelter system, such as one with more staffing.

In no case does the policy require the state to immediately expel someone with a past criminal offense, even a serious one such as murder, rape, child pornography, or sex trafficking, from the family shelter system.

Kevin Connor, a spokesman for the Executive Office of Housing and Liv-

BACKGROUND CHECKS, Page A10



MATTHEW J. LEE/GLOBE STAFF

BU TAKES THE BEANPOT — Boston University players celebrated with the trophy after stunning No. 1 Boston College, 4-1, at TD Garden on Monday night. The Terriers, who last won in 2022, now have their 32nd Beanpot crown. Freshman Cole Hutson, who scored the game-winning goal, earned tournament MVP honors. **C1.**